own theaters. This allowed them to take risks on people and stories.

It allowed the public to create real stars—legendary stars with staying power like Clark Gable, Olivia de Havilland, Gary Cooper, Jimmy Stewart, and a lot more.

A star like Judy Garland or Mickey Rooney wasn't born a great star. When a studio spotted people they thought had talent and promise—for instance, a pretty girl in a college play—they'd sign them up for a small salary and send them to classes where they were taught to act and sing and dance. Then they tried to nurture them, bring them up.

The studios knew *they* didn't make stars, the *public* did. But they could tailor movies to showcase an actor's particular talents, allow their talent to develop, and give them the backing of wonderful character actors and actresses who would never become stars. In those days, the great stars were built up over time and their names and faces became as familiar to people as their next of kin. The studio publicity machine saw to that. Every performer had a publicity agent whose responsibility it was to see that you were in the trade papers, the gossip columns, and the movie magazines: It built an image of you. That's what sold the tickets.

As a free lance, I agreed to make one picture a year for three years at Warner Brothers and was also able to make pictures at Paramount, MGM, RKO, and Universal. I finally got to do some westerns. Among them two of my favorites were *The Last Outpost* and *Cattle Queen of Montana*, with Barbara Stanwyck. In *The Last Outpost*, I teamed up with my favorite horse, Baby, the mare I rode and bought during *Stallion Road*.

During the late 1940s, one side effect of the attempted Communist infiltration of our industry was a kind of national backlash against Hollywood. The movie business became a popular target for politicians who attacked it as a hotbed of